Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-12 Monday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

90.75 USD/dmt

FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX · delayed

As of preparation: 2026-10-12 17:51:29 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-12 17:34:59 (UTC+8)

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

683.0 yuan/mt

▲ +0.5 +0.07%

MTD avg **682.7**

As of Oct 12 · vs Oct 9

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 12

Index	Value	Change	MTD avg
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily	661 yuan/wmt	▼ -3 -0.45%	663
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily	622 yuan/wmt	▼ -5 -0.80%	625
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily	824 yuan/wmt	▼ -4 -0.48%	827
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily	89.80 USD/dmt	▲ +0.60 +0.67%	91.20
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily	109.50 USD/dmt	▲ +0.10 +0.09%	110.22
SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily	821.58 yuan/mt	▼ -3.22 -0.39%	823.19

As of Oct 9 · vs Oct 8

Key View

Seaborne recovery contrasts with softer port prices; cost relief still needs a buying response

Today's market showed a seaborne recovery alongside softer port prices rather than broad-based strength. The 61% seaborne index rose to USD 89.80/dmt and the 65% to 109.50, while all 12 brand quotations gained USD 0.55–0.60. DCE most-traded edged up to 683.0 yuan/mt, but the 61%, 58% and 65% port indices fell to 661, 622 and 824 yuan/wmt. Reports of limited mill enquiries and thin trading suggest that firmer offers have yet to generate consistent demand support.

Costs and supply flows offer a marginal cushion. The second coke price cut took effect on Oct 12, potentially easing mill costs further, while latest global shipments and Chinese arrivals fell 5.02% and 4.05% WoW and freight continued lower. However, lower costs do not mean immediate expansion in output or purchases, and weaker shipments must pass through voyage and unloading schedules before affecting available supply. Lower domestic mine output alongside higher stocks also points to the importance of actual sales rather than supply reductions alone.

Near-term direction depends on whether margin repair generates sustained restocking. Pressure on end-user demand and finished-steel prices could keep mills focused on low stocks and immediate needs, limiting the durability of the seaborne rebound. Conversely, improved profitability and orders could gradually strengthen port trading. A low-level, range-bound outlook remains appropriate while watching whether transactions, mill production and inventories confirm one another.

Today's Highlights

- **Seaborne quotations recovered while port indices remained soft.** On Oct 12, the MMi 61% seaborne index was **USD 89.80/dmt**, up 0.60 (+0.67%), and the 65% was **109.50**, up 0.10 (+0.09%). The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 661, 622 and 824 yuan/wmt, down 3, 5 and 4 yuan from their previous readings.
- **All 12 seaborne brand quotations rose.** Against the Oct 9 report, PB Fines were USD 90.10/dmt (+0.67%), Newman Fines 89.20 (+0.62%) and Mac Fines 89.40 (+0.62%). Increases ranged from USD 0.55 to 0.60/dmt, but the durability of the rebound still depends on buying demand.
- **Domestic futures edged higher while spot brands diverged.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 683.0 yuan/mt, up 0.5 yuan (+0.07%) from Oct 9. Qingdao PB Fines at 648 and Newman Fines at 651 yuan/wmt each fell 2 yuan; Mac Fines rose 2 yuan to 652, Carajas Fines rose 1 yuan to 831, and PB Lump fell 11 yuan to 834.
- **The second coke price cut took effect, with the demand response still in focus.** SMM's Oct 12 coke briefing confirmed a second-round purchase-price reduction effective from midnight that day: 100 yuan/mt for wet-quenched and 110 yuan/mt for dry-quenched coke. This offers cost relief, but mills continued buying mainly to immediate needs and ore trading support still requires improvement.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-12 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	648	▼ -2 -0.31%	650	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	651	▼ -2 -0.31%	652	*
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	652	▲ +2 +0.31%	651	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	698	▼ -2 -0.29%	701	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	843	▼ -2 -0.24%	844	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	510	▼ -2 -0.39%	512	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	831	▲ +1 +0.12%	830	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	834	▼ -11 -1.30%	842	*

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-12 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-09
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	86.50	▲ +0.60 +0.70%	85.90
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	88.05	▲ +0.60 +0.69%	87.45
PB Fines 62% Daily	90.10	▲ +0.60 +0.67%	89.50
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	89.20	▲ +0.55 +0.62%	88.65
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	89.40	▲ +0.55 +0.62%	88.85
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	85.30	▲ +0.60 +0.71%	84.70
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	106.50	▲ +0.60 +0.57%	105.90
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	96.60	▲ +0.60 +0.62%	96.00
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	96.65	▲ +0.60 +0.62%	96.05
RTX Fines 61% Daily	85.05	▲ +0.60 +0.71%	84.45
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	89.45	▲ +0.55 +0.62%	88.90
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	78.70	▲ +0.60 +0.77%	78.10

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	91.20	-5.50%	-15.2%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	110.22	-3.68%	-9.8%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	663	-4.22%	-18.7%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	827	-1.54%	-8.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	625	-3.41%	-13.4%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	823.19	-1.83%	-7.3%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 89.80/dmt (+0.67%) and the 65% was 109.50 (+0.09%), narrowing their spread from USD 20.20 to 19.70/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 661, 622 and 824 yuan/wmt, down 3, 5 and 4 yuan from the previous readings.

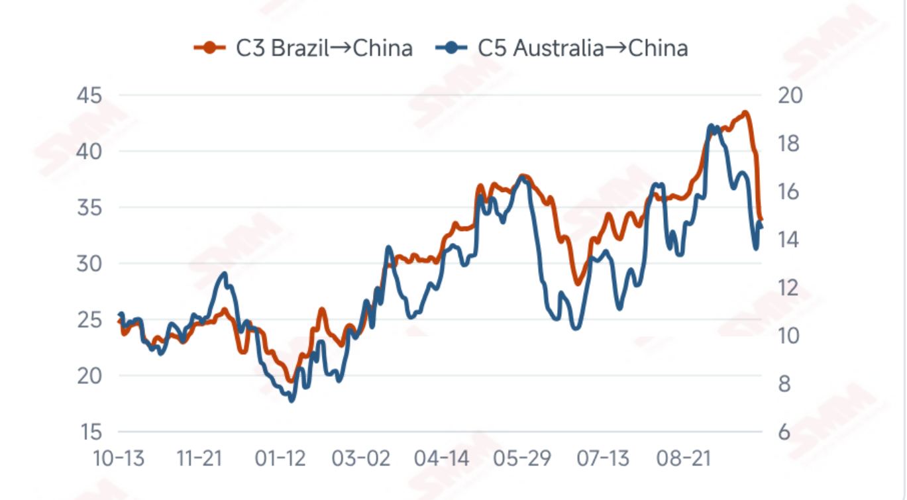
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

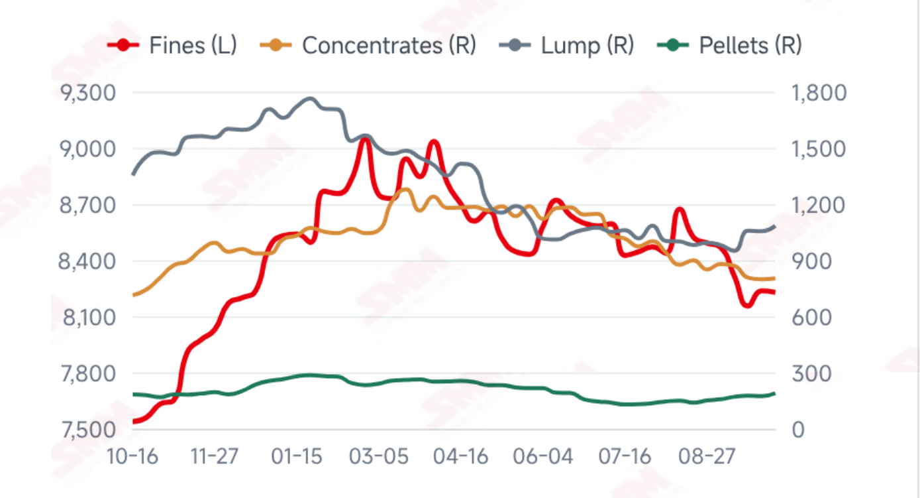
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



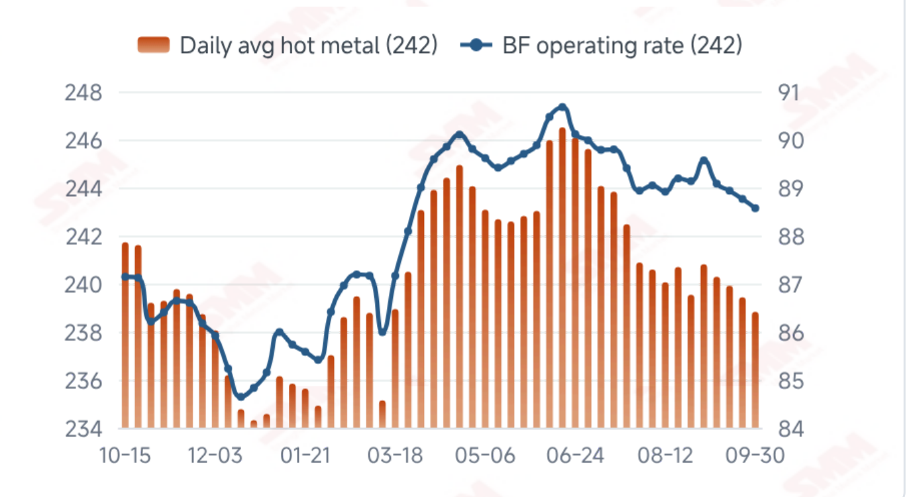
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



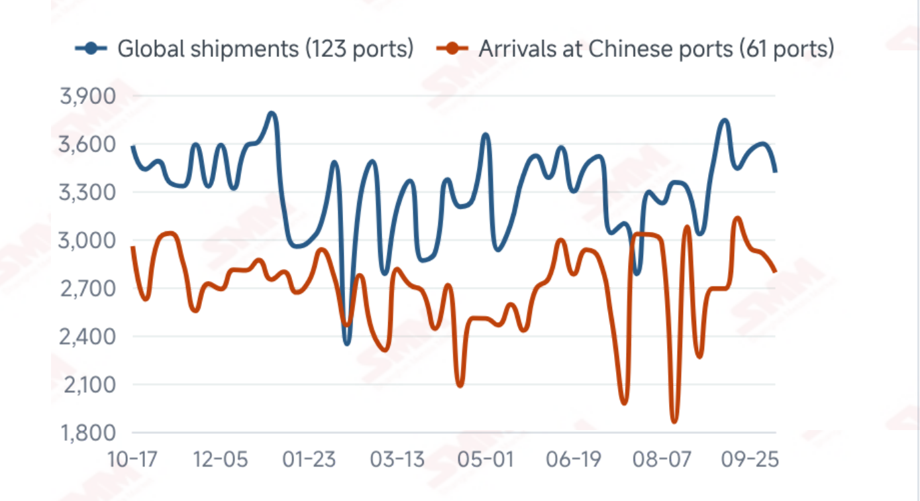
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 683.0 yuan/mt, up 0.07% from Oct 9. Qingdao PB Fines were 648, Newman Fines 651, BRBF 698, Newman Lump 843 and SSF 510 yuan/wmt, each down 2 yuan from the previous valid quotation; Mac Fines were 652 (+2), Carajas Fines 831 (+1) and PB Lump 834 (-11). SMM's daily review reported low trader activity, mills buying to immediate needs, limited enquiries and thin transactions. SGX official delayed data showed current-month FEFV26 at USD 90.75/dmt, timestamped Oct 12, 17:34:59 (UTC+8).
Drivers	Higher seaborne indices and brand quotations contrasted with lower composite port indices. The seaborne rebound may reflect a short-term recovery in offers and buying schedules, but thin port trading is not sufficient to establish a broad improvement in demand. The 61% seaborne index rose more than the 65%, narrowing their spread from USD 20.20 to 19.70/dmt. In contrast, the 65%-58% port spread widened from 201 to 202 yuan/wmt, so structural changes in the two markets should be assessed separately.
Demand	SMM's daily imported ore review judged that coke price cuts had eased mill costs, but weak end-user demand had prevented this from generating meaningful additional ore purchases. The latest 242-mill survey remained the Sep 30 reading of 2.3882 million mt of daily hot metal output and an 88.57% blast furnace operating rate. If mills continue controlling raw-material stocks and restocking only as needed, the seaborne rebound may feed slowly into port transactions. Further margin repair could improve buying appetite at the margin.
Inventory & supply	In the week to Oct 9, global iron ore shipments were 34.1393 million mt, down 1.8031 million mt (-5.02%) WoW; arrivals in China were 27.9147 million mt, down 1.1796 million mt (-4.05%). Brazilian shipments fell 18.31% to 7.0226 million mt, while Australian shipments edged up to 19.5081 million mt. Lower supply flows may ease subsequent arrival pressure, but existing port stocks and mill demand remain important to the balance. The latest available 10-port inventory was 103.0165 million mt as of Sep 30.
Cost & margin	The second-round coke purchase-price cut took effect at midnight on Oct 12, reducing wet-quenched and dry-quenched coke by 100 and 110 yuan/mt, respectively. This offers mill cost relief, while further cuts remain an expectation. SMM's imported ore cost-and-margin table put the period's average import margin at 15.37 yuan/mt, up from 14.22; this measures import trading rather than steelmaking profitability. Oct 9 freight was USD 33.68/mt for C3 (-2.21%) and 14.39/mt for C5 (-2.04%), potentially improving cost conditions for some cargoes.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 821.58 yuan/mt on Oct 9, down 0.39% from the previous reading. Imported ore prices and mill margins remain influences on domestic concentrate bargaining.
Supply & demand	SMM's mine production and sales survey published on Oct 12 reported capacity utilisation of 57.3% for the survey week, down 0.8 percentage point WoW. Concentrate output fell 28,000 mt to 870,000 mt, while mine concentrate stocks increased 15,000 mt to about 263,000 mt. Lower output alongside rising inventory suggests that reduced supply does not necessarily improve sales support immediately.
Outlook	Concentrate supply may recover as some operations resume after holiday maintenance. If mill buying remains cautious, mine destocking could face pressure. The demand benefit from lower coke costs depends on the extent of improvement in finished-steel margins, leaving domestic ore potentially soft and differentiated across regions in the near term.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

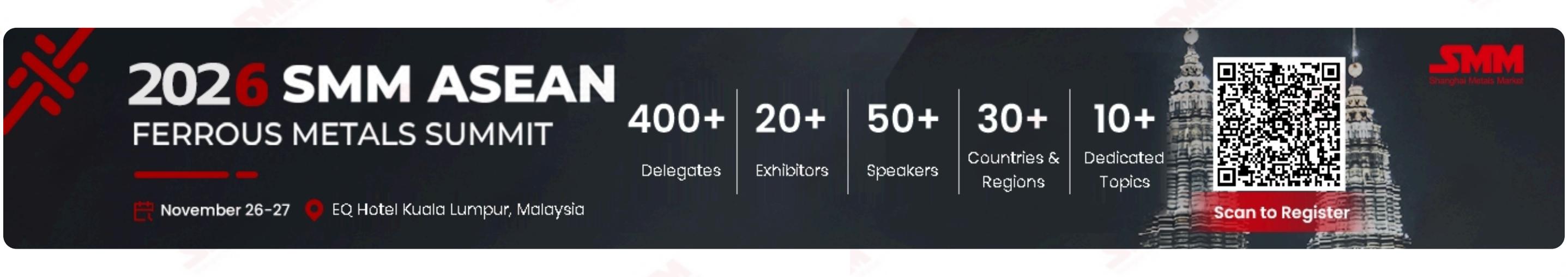
- Both seaborne indices and all 12 brand quotations recovered.
- The second coke price cut took effect, easing mill cost pressure.
- Latest global shipments and Chinese arrivals fell 5.02% and 4.05% WoW, respectively.
- C3 and C5 freight eased further, lowering transport costs for some cargoes.

▼ Bearish factors

- All three composite port indices declined while spot brands diverged.
- SMM reported limited enquiries, needs-based mill buying and thin trading.
- Weak end-user demand may constrain the transmission of cost relief to purchasing.
- Surveyed domestic mine output fell while stocks rose, indicating pressure on sales support.

Flash News

- [SMM Iron Ore] Coke price cuts fail to lift iron ore buying as prices stay low ↗
  2026-10-12
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Briefing] 20261012 ↗
  2026-10-12
- [SMM Steel] Vietnam HRC Buyers Shift to Domestic Supply as Import Trading Slows ↗
  2026-10-12
- [SMM Steel] Indian HRC Export Interest Remains Subdued; Domestic Demand Supports Prices ↗
  2026-10-12
- [SMM Steel] India Steel Prices Fall Amid Subdued Trading ↗
  2026-10-12
- [SMM Steel] Indonesian Wire Rod Slips $3/mt to $502 FOB as Major Mill Cuts Price to Defend Market Share ↗
  2026-10-12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FERROUS METALS SUMMIT
November 26-27 EQ Hotel Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia
400+ Delegates
20+ Exhibitors
50+ Speakers
30+ Countries & Regions
10+ Dedicated Topics
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Contact Us - (Email :prices@mmiprices.com)

Shu Qing
Domestic Information Sales
+86 187 8199 7577

Wang Jiahui
Domestic Information Sales
+86 155 2492 4450

Leah Zhang
Overseas Information Sales
+86 136 6193 3462

Jack Teah
Overseas Analyst
+60 11 6680 1225

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